

Spencer Butler

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Summary

Infrastructure Engineer with 20+ years of experience operating and deploying large-scale systems across datacenter and production environments. Proven track record in hardware bring-up, failure analysis, and infrastructure deployment, including early datacenter expansion at Google and rapid deployment environments at Groq. Known for identifying complex system issues early and driving them to resolution across hardware and software layers.

Core Skills

- Datacenter Operations & Deployment
- Infrastructure Bring-up & Hardware Validation
- Linux / Unix Systems (FreeBSD, OpenBSD, Linux)
- Automation (Puppet, Bash, Python)
- Monitoring & Observability (Check_MK, LibreNMS)
- Load Balancing & Web Infrastructure (HAProxy, Nginx, Apache)
- Failure Analysis & Debugging
- API & Internal Tooling Development

Professional Experience

Groq — Infrastructure Engineer (Systems)

July 2024 – April 2025

Supported rapid deployment of datacenter infrastructure in a high-growth AI environment Worked closely with infrastructure leadership to bring systems online at speed while maintaining operational stability Contributed to hardware deployment, system validation, and early-stage infrastructure operations

Honeycomb Internet Services — Unix Systems Administrator / DevOps

June 2017 – November 2023

Designed and implemented monitoring systems across server and network infrastructure using Check_MK and LibreNMS Developed Puppet-based automation for deploying and configuring monitoring agents across heterogeneous systems Built internal tools and APIs (Flask, Python) to support infrastructure visibility and operational workflows Wrote custom monitoring plugins for Linux, OpenBSD, and FreeBSD environments Diagnosed and resolved complex system and application issues across production environments

Reflected Networks — Linux Systems Administrator

July 2010 – September 2015

Maintained high-availability infrastructure supporting critical customer-facing services Deployed and managed web and application stack (HAProxy, Nginx, Apache, MySQL) Supported high-traffic CDN origin systems using Lighttpd Collaborated with distributed teams to ensure reliability and uptime across production systems

Google — Data Center Technician / Infrastructure Operations

October 2006 – September 2009

Played a key role in turning up Google's Iowa datacenter, including infrastructure deployment and team leadership Worked directly with Platforms Development teams to test and validate new server hardware Identified hardware and deployment issues during early platform rollouts, improving system reliability Produced extensive operational documentation supporting large-scale infrastructure deployment

Twin Cities Open Systems — Infrastructure Consultant

August 2001 – Current

Delivered infrastructure consulting, custom systems, and software solutions across diverse environments Designed and implemented Linux-based systems, automation workflows, and monitoring solutions Supported a wide range of infrastructure projects from small business systems to complex deployments